

Shapes

Inkscape provides a number of tools for drawing geometric shapes. The tools for drawing regular geometric shapes (rectangles, ellipses, regular polygons, stars, and spirals) are covered here. Path (pencil and pen) tools, discussed in the next section, may be used to draw arbitrary shapes. The style of an object includes attributes that determine how the inside of the shape (fill) and how the boundary path (stroke) are drawn. It also includes shape-specific attributes such as the number of points in a star. New objects are drawn with the current style. The fill and stroke paint colours as well as the stroke thickness of the current style are shown for the shape and path tools at the right end of the tool controls.

The Rectangle Tool Controls showing the current fill colour (blue) and stroke colour (black), as well as the stroke width (1 pixel).

While drawing some objects such as arcs, stars, regular polygons, and spirals, some features such as the orientation of a polygon can be constrained to specific angles with respect to the centre of the shape and the horizontal axis. These angles are multiples of the rotation snap angle. The default snap angle is 15 deg. It can be set under the steps entry in the Inkscape preferences dialog.

Shapes can be scaled, rotated, and skewed. When doing so, a transformation is applied to the shape. The internal parameters defining the shape such as the width and height of an ellipse remain unchanged. This is important to remember if you later modify a shape, for example, by editing the XML file directly.

The star tool includes a randomization feature so that the resulting shapes are not regular. The underlying description is still based on a regular shape.

This is not always true for rectangles. If the option optimised is selected in the store transformation section of the transforms entry of the Inkscape preferences dialog, the x, y, width and